

Applications are closed. All places for the consultation are filled.

Due to the exceptionally high interest from entrepreneurs, the Agency is organizing another consultation titled "5 Years of GDPR Implementation: Problems, Solutions, Penalties, and Examples of Good Practice" on Wednesday, May 24, 2023, in collaboration with the Croatian Employers' Association, at Radnička cesta 37a, 10000, Zagreb, starting at 10:00 AM.

This consultation is organized by the Agency and HUP on the occasion of the 5th anniversary of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), a legal regulation that has been fully applicable in the European Union since May 25, 2018, marking a turning point in the field of personal data protection and significantly changing the awareness of the importance of personal data protection among businesses and individuals. This consultation is an activity within the EU project ARC2, which the Agency is implementing to support micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises in aligning their operations with data protection regulations.

The aim of the General Data Protection Regulation is to protect the personal data of individuals, provide citizens with control over their personal data, and create a high and uniform level of personal data protection in the European Union.

The General Data Protection Regulation defines the rights of individuals and, accordingly, the obligations of entities processing personal data. All business entities that collect, store, and in any way process the personal data of Croatian citizens and citizens from the European Economic Area are required to apply the General Data Protection Regulation.

Furthermore, we would like to particularly emphasize on the 5th anniversary of the GDPR: all organizations that process personal data must be aware of the rights of individuals regarding the processing of their personal data and enable them to exercise their rights.

Numerous supervisory and educational activities conducted by the Agency have clearly shown that the level of compliance with the legislative framework for data protection in the Republic of Croatia is not at a satisfactory level. The Agency continuously provides support primarily to data protection officers and micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises through EU projects ARC and ARC2.

It is high time for companies, public authorities, and all data controllers/processors to understand that the deadline for adjustment has long passed and that after 5 years from the start of full GDPR implementation, ignorance and lack of knowledge can no longer serve as justification and excuse for violating the fundamental rights of Croatian and European citizens.

Moreover, on this occasion, the Agency wants to highlight the key role that data protection officers have in the personal data protection system, as they are often the weakest link. In addition to having appropriate knowledge in the field of personal data protection, officers must have a good understanding of the business processes of the organization in which they work, continuously educate themselves, and also educate employees in the organization where they operate as officers.

The goal of organizing this consultation is to provide data controllers/processors and data protection officers with the opportunity to familiarize themselves with the latest trends and examples of good practice in the field of personal data protection, share with AZOP experts the problems they encounter in the application of the GDPR, and, with their support, find solutions that will raise the level of compliance in their organizations to a higher level.

The Agency emphasizes that investing in personal data protection and information security is no longer just a necessary and desirable investment, but has become an essential and indispensable investment for successful business operations.

The GDPR has come to stay, and data protection will become increasingly important in the era of big data and artificial intelligence, as evidenced by the example of the ban on Chat GPT in Italy, where its use was prohibited by the Italian data protection authority due to violations of the GDPR.

CONSULTATION PROGRAM:

10:00 – 10:10 Opening Speeches

Iva Nappholz, Legal Advisor for Projects and Support to Sectoral Associations from the Croatian Employers' Association, Member of the Advisory Board of the ARC2 Project

Igor Vulje, Deputy Director of the Agency for Personal Data Protection

10:10 – 10:20 Presentation of the ARC2 Project

Iva Nappholz, Legal Advisor for Projects and Support to Sectoral Associations from the Croatian Employers' Association, Member of the Advisory Board of the ARC2 Project

10:20 – 11:10 “Aligning Business Processes with GDPR: Where Do Organizations Most Often Go Wrong?”

Marko Trošelj, Master of Law, Head of the Department for International Data Transfers and Compliance Mechanisms, Agency for Personal Data Protection

11:10 – 12:10 “Supervisory and Investigative Activities of AZOP: What You Need to Know and How to Prepare?”

Siniša Kovačić, Head of the Department for Supervision, Investigations, Technology, and Security

12:10 – 13:00 BREAK

13:00 – 14:00 “Penalties for Violators of the GDPR and the Law on the Implementation of the General Data Protection Regulation: Practice of AZOP and EU Data Protection Supervisory Authorities”

Antonio Katavić, Senior Specialist Advisor, Agency for Personal Data Protection